Wenzel Massag,

Human Interface Designer (UX, UI)

I earned a degree in **Media Design (B.Sc.)** and I'm a self-taught front-end web developer. I specialize in **design systems, UX and UI design.**

My programming skills enable me to collaborate effectively with developers and utilize AI.

0049 (0) 174 894 0 954

mail@wenzelmassag.de

www.wenzelmassag.de

Directory

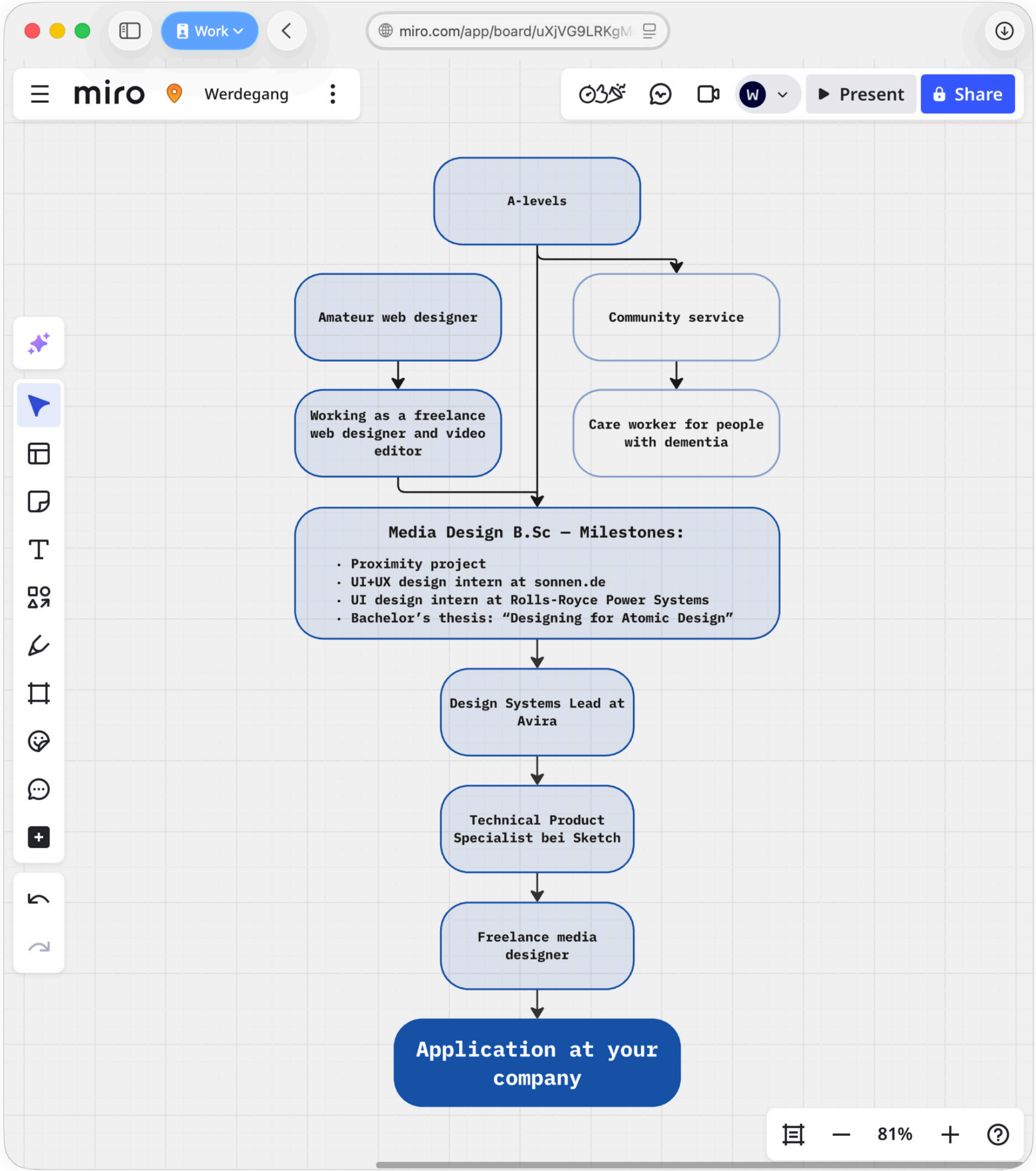


Fig. 1: Visualisation of my CV on Miro (screenshot).

Design Systems and UI Design

In a nutshell

At **Rolls-Royce Power Systems,** I developed the “Torque” design system in collaboration with experts from **InVision.** I expanded on this knowledge in my bachelor’s thesis and put the results of my research into practice at **Avira,** where I was the **product owner** of the **white-label design system** “Umbrella”.

At **Sketch,** as a Technical Support Specialist, I had the opportunity to work with **Apple and LG,** among others.

As Sketch’s clients often used both Sketch and Figma, I familiarized myself with **Figma** in my spare time. Nowadays, I prefer to work in Figma and am very proficient in both applications.

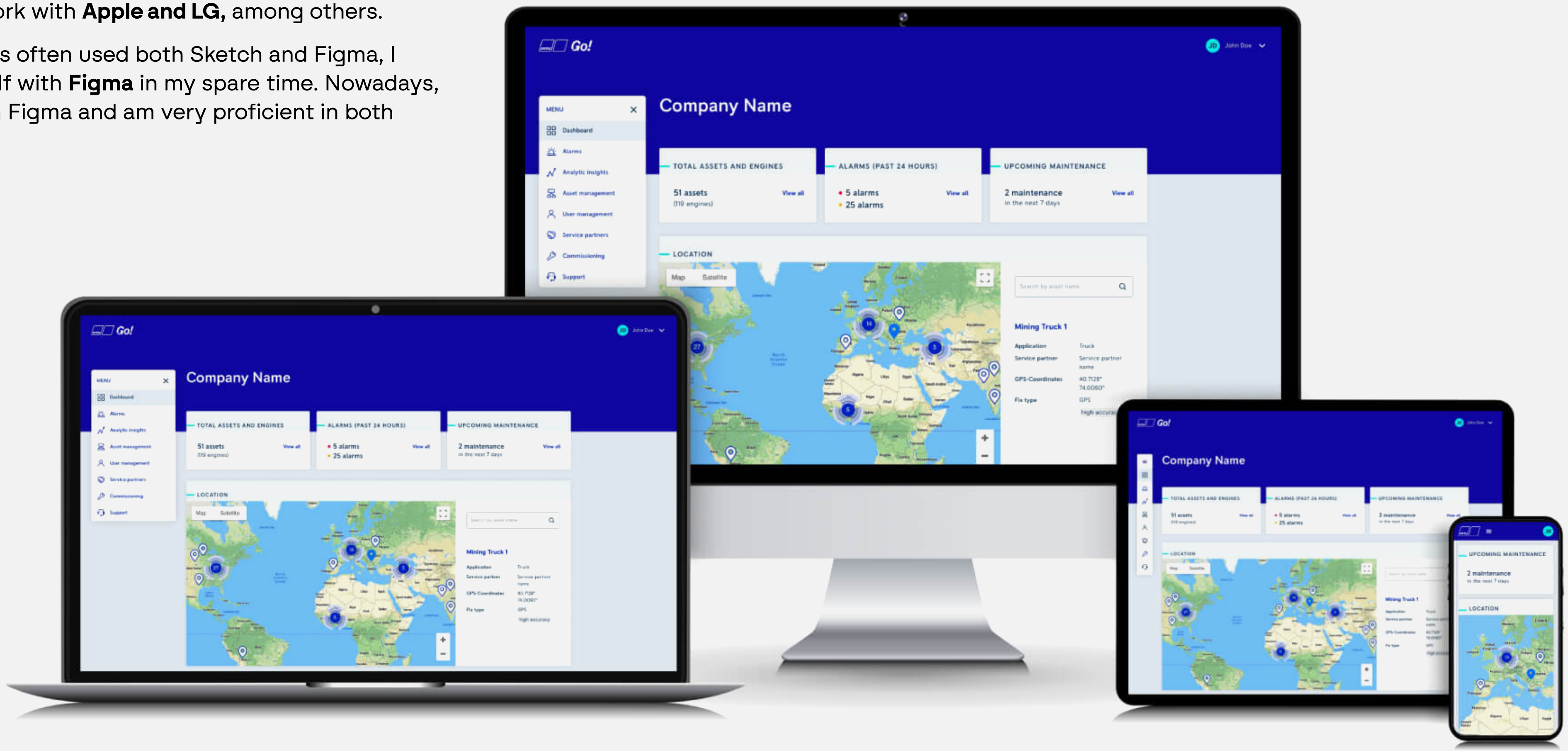


Fig. 2: Promotional graphic for ‘MTU Go!’ by Rolls-Royce Power-Systems. The web and iOS applications are based on the ‘Torque’ design system, which I helped to develop.

Mission Statement

I see the increasingly complex demands placed on UX and UI design as an opportunity for better design. Designers and product managers must comply with the EU AI Act, GDPPR and accessibility regulations. Keeping track of all these requirements can distract from design objectives. It can become exhausting and negatively impact the product.

Fortunately, design systems can significantly simplify this complexity by allowing designers to systematically incorporate solutions for legal requirements. **I would like to take on this role and thereby ease the burden on the design and development process.** I aim to make lasting improvements to the products of my employers and clients, while also reducing the long-term costs of maintenance and modernization.

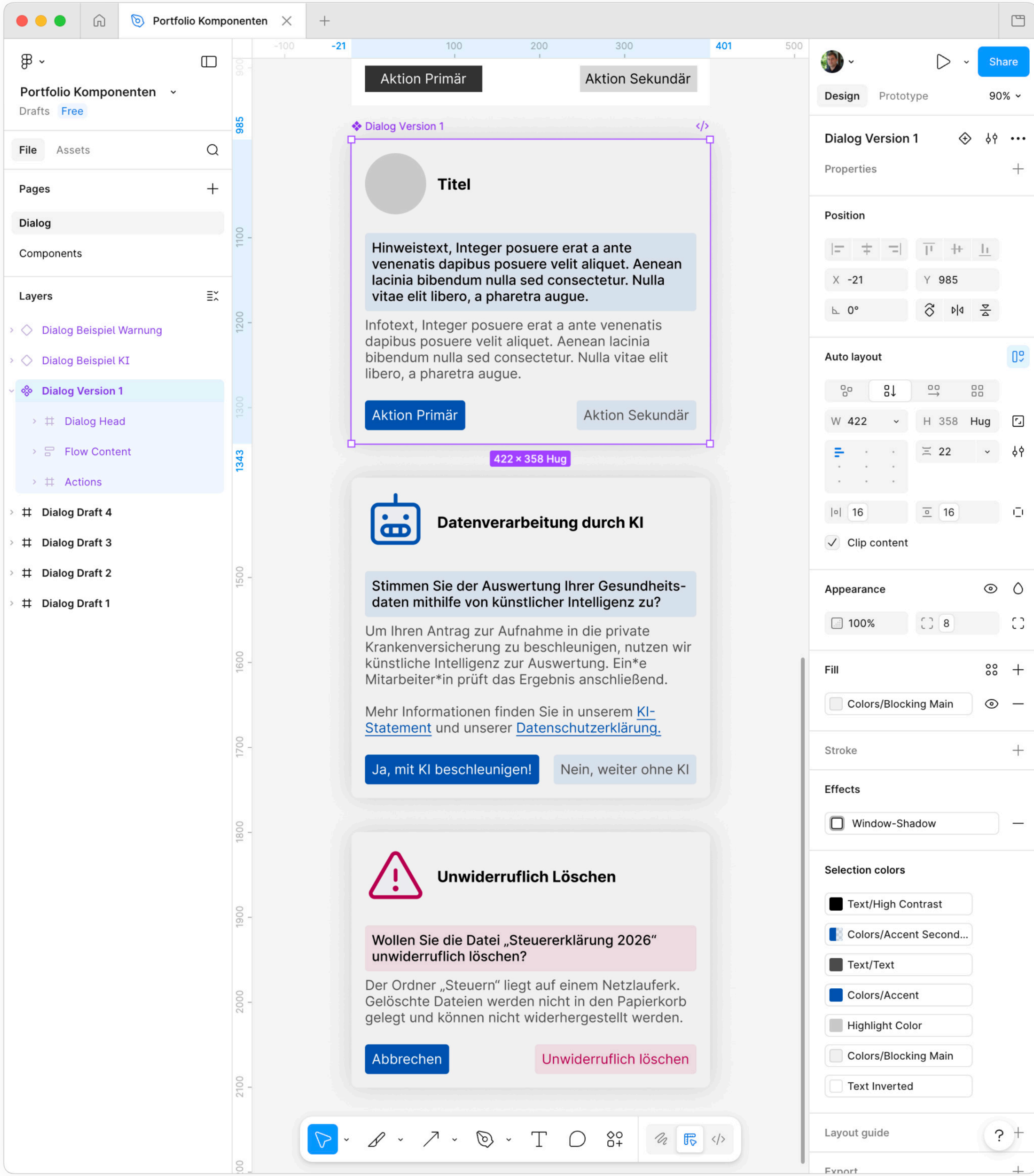


Fig. 3: In Figma, a dialogue component with examples of AI consent in accordance with the EU AI Act, and deletion.

White-label design system for Avira & Norton

As part of the design team at Avira, we created the ‘Umbrella’ design system for web and Windows products. Following the acquisition by NortonLifeLock, I was tasked with exploring the development of a white-label design system.

The aim was to **enable a one-click switch between Avira and Norton branding for finished designs in Sketch.** Today, this could be achieved using **AI via the MCP API** in Sketch or Figma.

Roles: Owner of the Umbrella design system, UI designer.

Duration: six months full-time, 100% remote.

Responsibilities:

- Planning and implementation of the design system in Sketch based on existing screen designs and individual icons.
- Documentation of all components and tokens in Frontify.
- Investigating options for automatic code generation for front-end development.

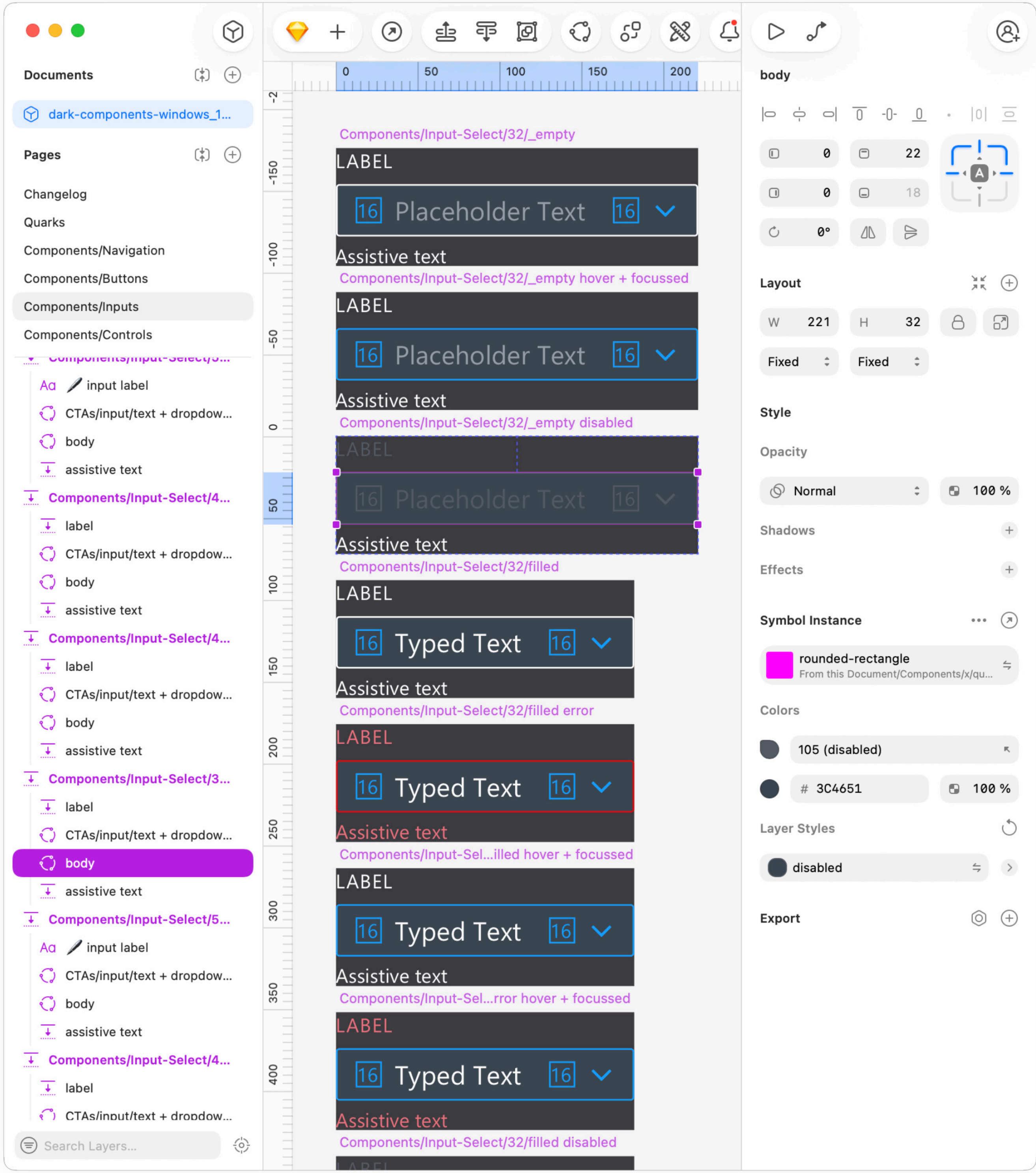


Fig. 4: Umbrella Library for Avira in Sketch. The inspector shows the text field’s shape (body) is a replaceable Symbol.

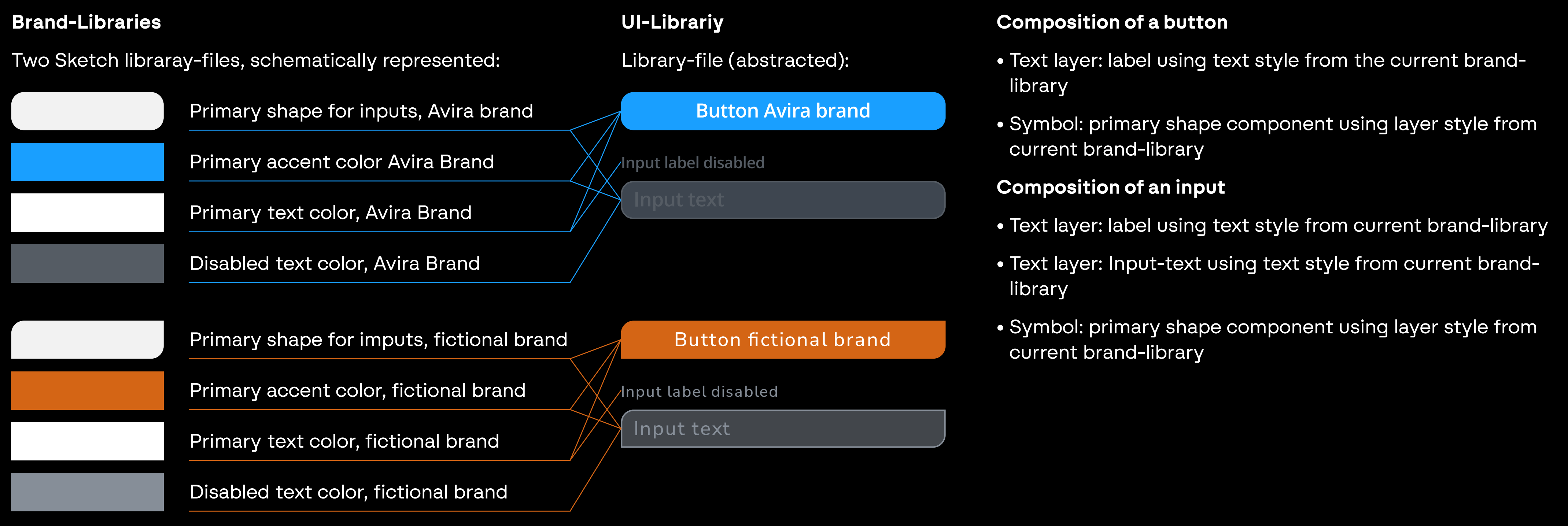


Fig. 5: Simplified illustration depicting the modular construction of a white-label design system. Left column: Schematic representation of two brand asset libraries. Middle column: A button and a text input field. The upper section is linked to the Avira brand library, whilst the lower section shows the same components linked to a fictional brand library. Right column: Layer list of the components.

Decisions: Why, what, for whom and how?

To start, I developed a proposed workflow and presented it to Avira's design team for feedback. Thanks to lively participation, I was able to tailor the workflow more effectively to my colleagues' needs. Once Avira's Head of Design gave the 'green light' to proceed, I began working on the implementation.

My proposed workflow aimed to enable quick switching of branding for the UI in Sketch during the design process. To save time, each screen was to be created only once for all brands, rather than once per brand.

I began implementing the workflow by creating a prototype in Sketch and testing it with stakeholders. Only then did I convert the Umbrella Sketch Library into an extended Atomic Design Library. For this, I used the process I had developed in my bachelor's thesis.

The idea was simple and effective: I moved shapes, colours, typography, and icons into a separate Brand Assets Sketch Library (Fig. 5). With the help of the 'Automator' plugin, the Brand Assets Sketch Libraries could be swapped within the Umbrella Library, allowing finished designs to be switched between brands with a single click.

Using AI in Figma and Sketch

Today, I would approach this project much more efficiently by making targeted use of AI, Figma Auto Layout and Slots. I believe that AI tools such as OpenCode and the **MCP interfaces in Figma and Sketch** have the potential to significantly boost the efficiency gains already achieved thanks to design systems.

If I were to construct the Umbrella architecture today, it would involve significantly less manual work. The link between design and code can now be increasingly automated through AI.

Designing for Atomic Design

In my bachelor's thesis, I explored how I could help designers produce better deliverables that would be more easily understood by developers. The result was an expanded Atomic Design process, which I documented as "Designing for Atomic Design". I addressed the research question using the Double Diamond process, based on literature reviews and interviews with a panel of eight experts.

Brad Frost devised the "Atomic Design" process in 2013. It was conceived as a combined software development and design process to combat the proliferation of visual clutter on websites, which had grown unchecked over time. Simultaneously, it aims to simplify front-end code. I reinterpreted Atomic Design from a design perspective and devised a proposed process that incorporated design tokens. Drawing on the naming convention of Atomic Design, I called the tokens "ions".

Outlook for 2026

Most design tokens can nowadays be stored as Variables and Styles in Figma. Linking these token variables to Storybook would be the next logical step in my proposed process.

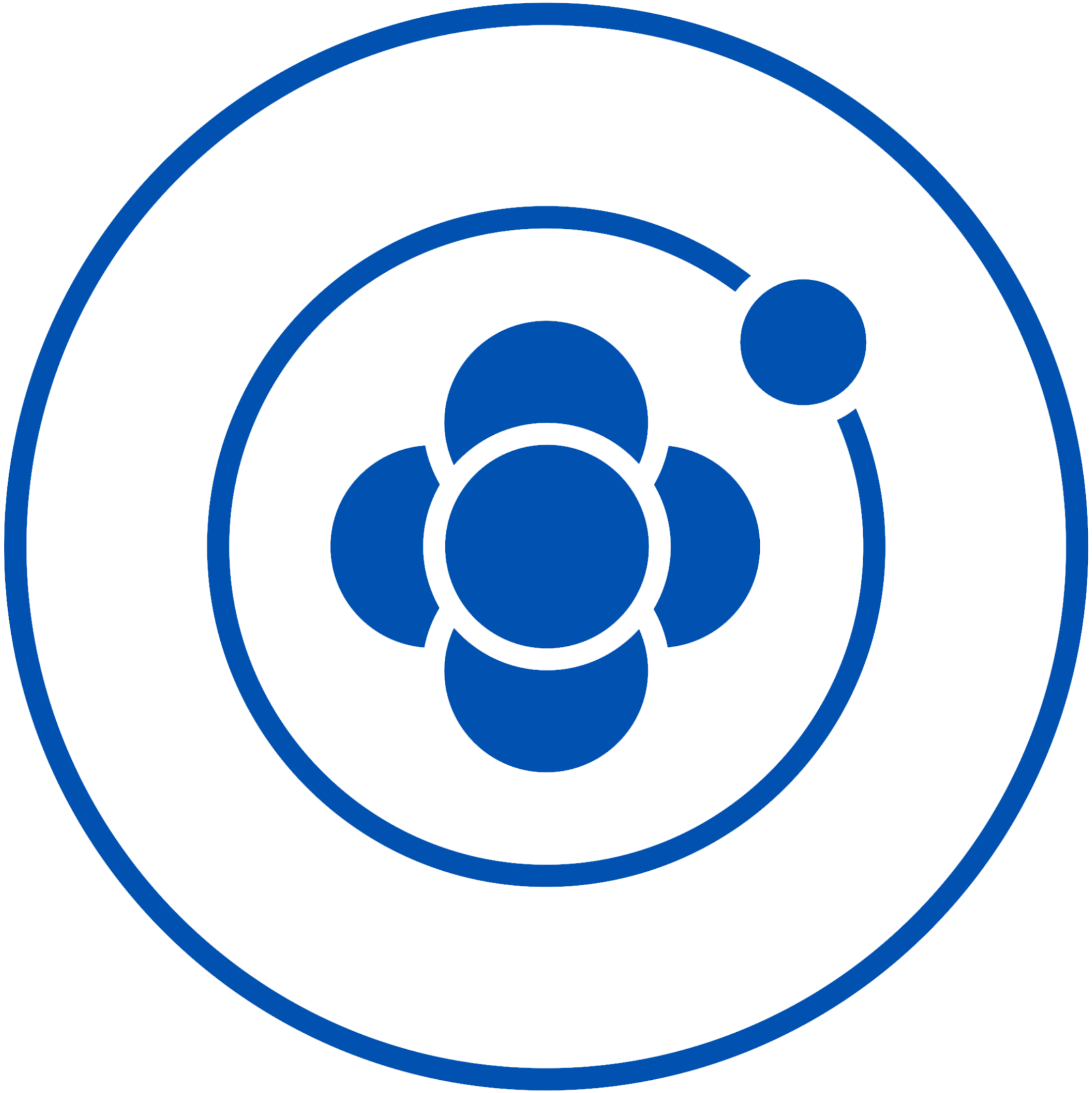


Fig. 6: Logo design for 'Designing for Atomic Design', based on the Atomic Design logo.

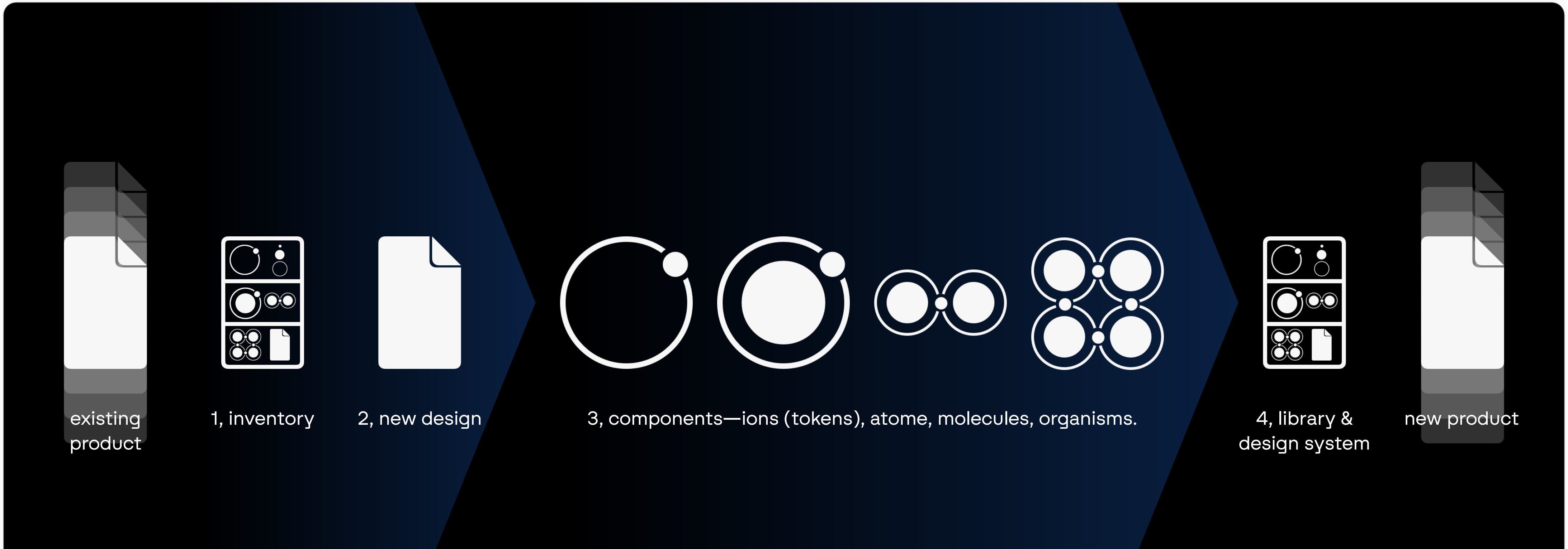


Abb 7: Visualisierung der Schritte in Designing for Atomic Design.

My Proposed Process

I propose a UI design process entitled “Designing for Atomic Design”. **My process simultaneously lays the groundwork for a design system and produces a final deliverable,** such as a finished app or web design. Today, I propose adding another step to the process to synchronize design tokens between design software and code.

1 If it's a redesign, the process optionally begins with an inventory. This involves documenting the published product with screenshots.

2 Next, we design one to three frames in tools like Figma, Sketch or PenPot. Here, a frame is either a webpage or an app screen. The fewer frames created, the better the process works; I will therefore refer to a frame in the singular below.

The frame is designed in such detail that it remains unchanged during design review. The time invested here pays off exponentially later in the process.

3 Following this, the elements of the frame are broken down into components according to the Atomic Design scheme, with additional ‘ions’ (design tokens) created as variables.

Components in this context include, for example, a button (atom), an input field with placeholder text and a label (molecule), but also a complete navigation component (organism), composed of simpler components such as navigation items (atoms) and category headings (atoms).

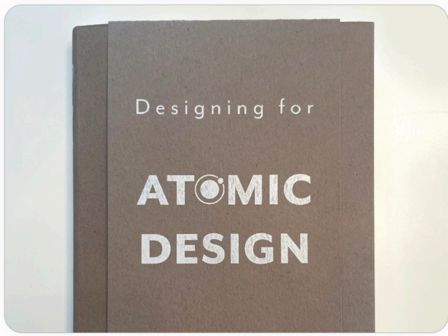
From this point onwards, a component library exists within the design tool. Its components will work well together, as they all come from one cohesive frame.

4 The UI and design system team can now use the library as a basis for the design system. At the same time, it is immediately available to the UX team for creating prototypes quickly and easily.

Table of Contents

Printing, Layout and Typography

Alongside my theoretical work, I devoted considerable time to printing, layout and typography. I compiled my bachelor's thesis into a 150-page book using Adobe InDesign. To this end, I developed a visual identity, which I also incorporated into the design concept of a website.



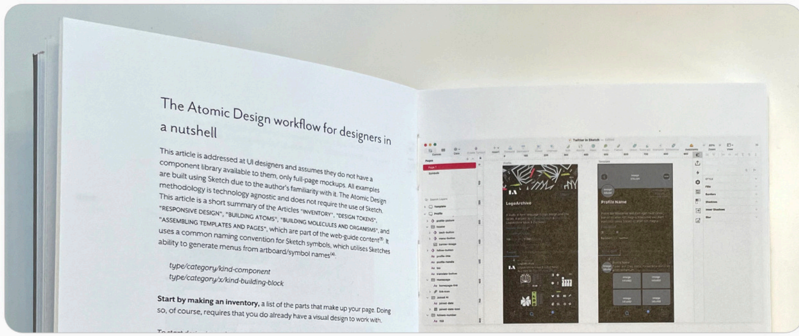


Fig. 8 (top): The table of contents of 'Designing for Atomic Design'. Fig. 9 (centre): A photo of the book cover. Fig. 10 (right): A photo of the book's contents.

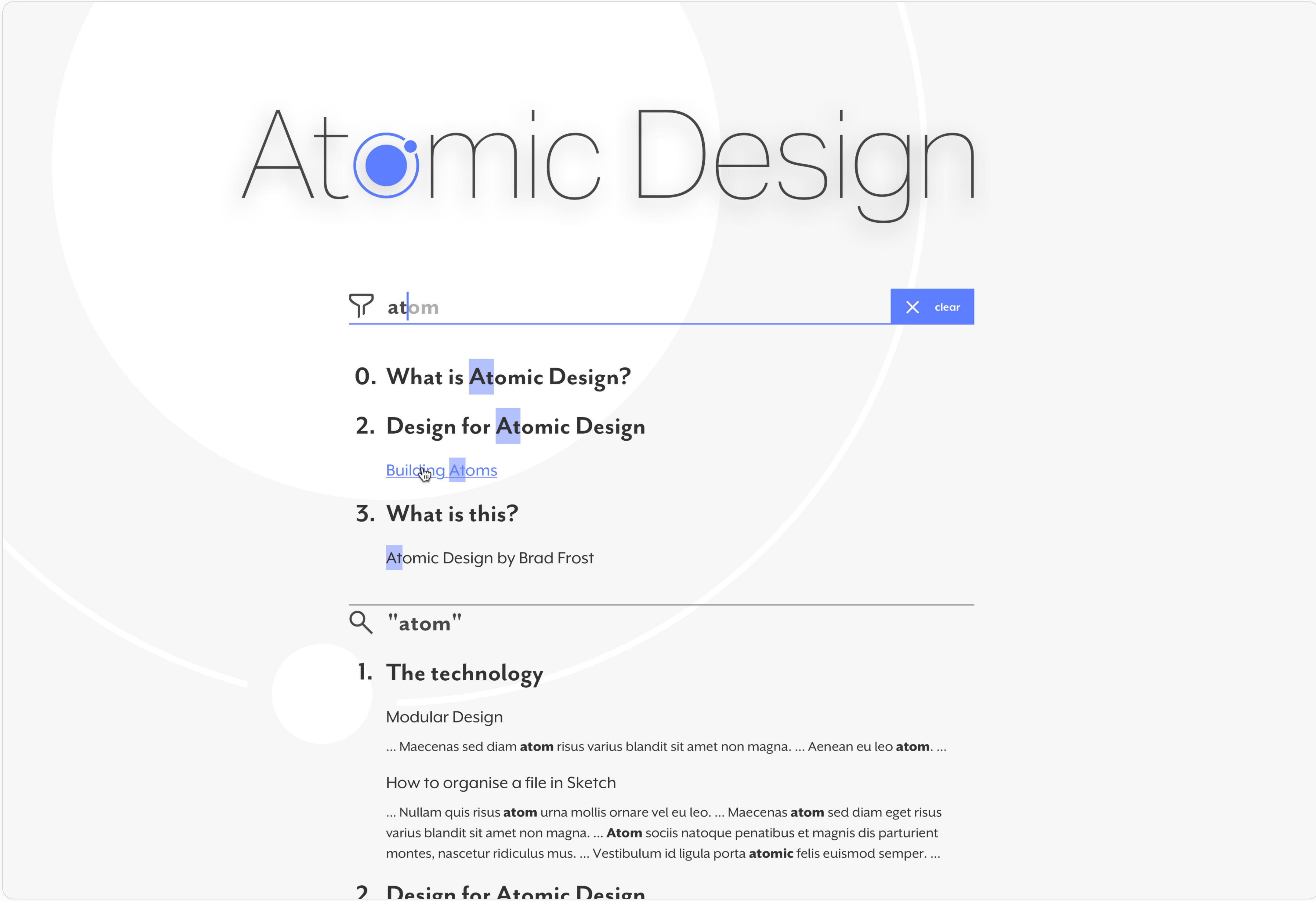


Fig. 11: Mock-up of the website for my bachelor’s thesis. In this mockup, I presented the search function on the home page with predictive autocomplete.

Human Interface Design (UX, UI)

Overview

I am passionate about beautiful, user-friendly, intuitive and fast software. Human-centred design is my passion, and I cherish every opportunity to collaborate on human interface design.

In addition to the projects presented below, the following activities were personal highlights:

I had the opportunity to help design the onboarding process for new and existing customers at sonnen.de. This involved developing the user flow on Miro and the corresponding screens in Sketch.

As part of the team at Sketch.com, I was able to contribute to the design of the web application (Workspace) and the macOS application (Sketch). As a Technical Product Specialist, I tested pre-release software and worked closely with developers.

Below, I would like to showcase two examples of work for which I hold the necessary rights to showcase. My work for the Bodenseekreis District Media Centre (a government run library and technology resource for public schools) consisted of **content design, information architecture** and technical consultancy. For the Proximity project, I was able to focus equally on **UX research and UI design.**

Information architecture for the Bodenseekreis District Media Centre

Working on a freelance basis, I had the opportunity to help the Bodenseekreis District Media Centre, a government run library and technology resource for public schools, to bring its new website to life with content. Though, the name is commonly abbreviated as “KMZ”, short for “Kreismedienzentrum”.

Through **targeted one-to-one training sessions and group workshops,** I empowered the staff to design and organize the website independently in future. **Together, we developed the information architecture and published the first version of all content.**

Roles: Content Designer, UX Designer, Project Manager, Consultant, and Coach.

Duration: three years, 100% remote.

Tasks:

- Designing the information architecture for the website,
- Content design for some texts and images used on the website,
- Organizing and running content and strategy workshops,
- One-to-one coaching for staff,
- Drafting specifications for tenders.

Fig. 12: ‘Educational Advice’ and ‘FAQs’ clusters on the KMZ’s Miro board.

Decisions: What and for whom? How and why?

The Bodenseekreis District Media Centre (KMZ) contacted me after it had already paid for a redesign of its website. It had received no support with planning, creating or publishing content, and the project was in danger of failing, with significant financial consequences. In a series of workshops, I helped the team present its services from a customer's perspective.

To develop a clear picture of the expected workload, we began with an inventory. We compiled all the services offered as well as quantifiable observations from day-to-day work on a Miro board.

We organized the collected items into clusters (Figure 12), which we grouped into website pages (Figure 13). **This enabled us to ensure that all known requirements were met and to avoid duplication of content on the site, despite the team consisting of nine members.**

We organized the resulting pages into a sitemap and developed a navigation structure. The result was a clear picture of what content should be presented where on the website. **This also made it clear for what purpose and for which target audience the respective pages should be created.**

Following this, I helped the team establish an ownership structure for the website. One person was given responsibility for the blog, another for the events section, and so on. We assigned all sections until a responsible person had been appointed for each one.

Staff members were now able to delegate tasks among themselves in a clearly structured manner, based on the strengths of each team member. In one-to-one workshops, I helped staff write copy, select images and create illustrations. Today, the website always reflects the KMZ's current offering, and KMZ staff update the website independently, in line with the team's flat hierarchy.

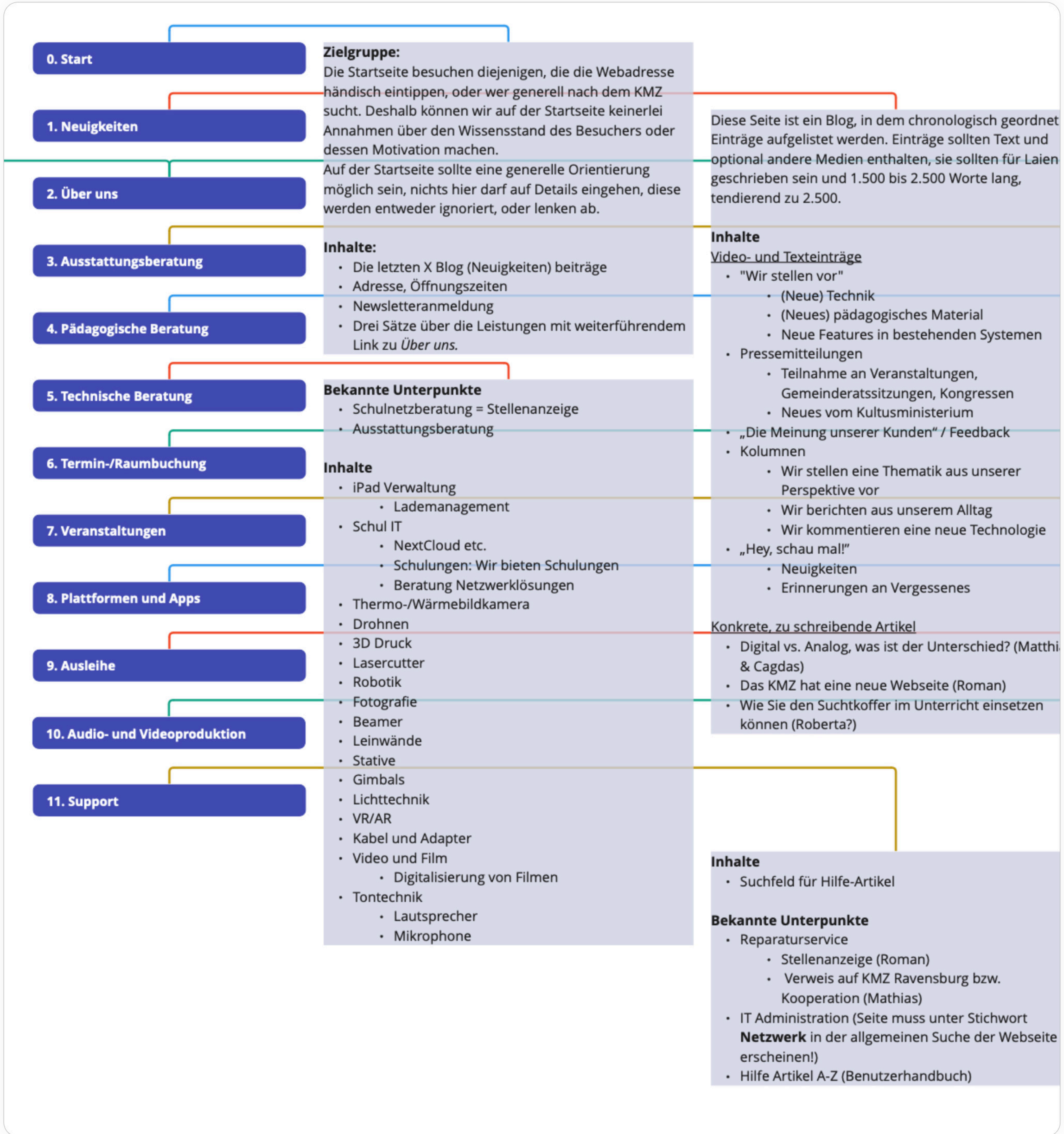


Fig. 13: A section of the Miro board showing the content plan. It shows the eleven pages created and, in some cases, the planned content, as well as the target audience. It also includes any known subpages whose content is to be created and published at a later date.

Proximity: The fourth dimension of your city

As part of my design degree, I had the opportunity to undertake two six-month UX+UI projects. In one of these, I developed the iOS app concept ‘Proximity’. I based Proximity on real-world data and would like to present it here.

Activities: UX research, UX design, UI design

Tasks:

- Planning, conducting and evaluating user surveys
- Developing and validating UX concepts and UI designs
- Designing a mock-up/prototype
- Pitching to a public audience
- Documentation in the form of a booklet

PDF download: www.wenzelmassag.de/proximity

Problem statement and proposed solution

> “It’s becoming increasingly difficult to reach and motivate young people!”

The employee from the City of Weingarten had got up during her comments following a presentation on **citizen engagement** and was venting her frustration. She spoke about the failed attempts at communication between the administration and citizens. I was sitting in the audience, listening with keen interest as she described the difficulties she and her colleagues faced daily.

In summary, she explained that it was a mystery to her and colleagues in other cities just how they could reach citizens “these days”. According to her, conventional methods had all become ineffective, as nobody seemed to read noticeboards or local newspapers, and even billboards were largely ignored. After a few more comments from members of the municipal administration in the audience, it became clear that there exists an **‘experience gap’** here. Prof. Karl T. Ulrich defines an

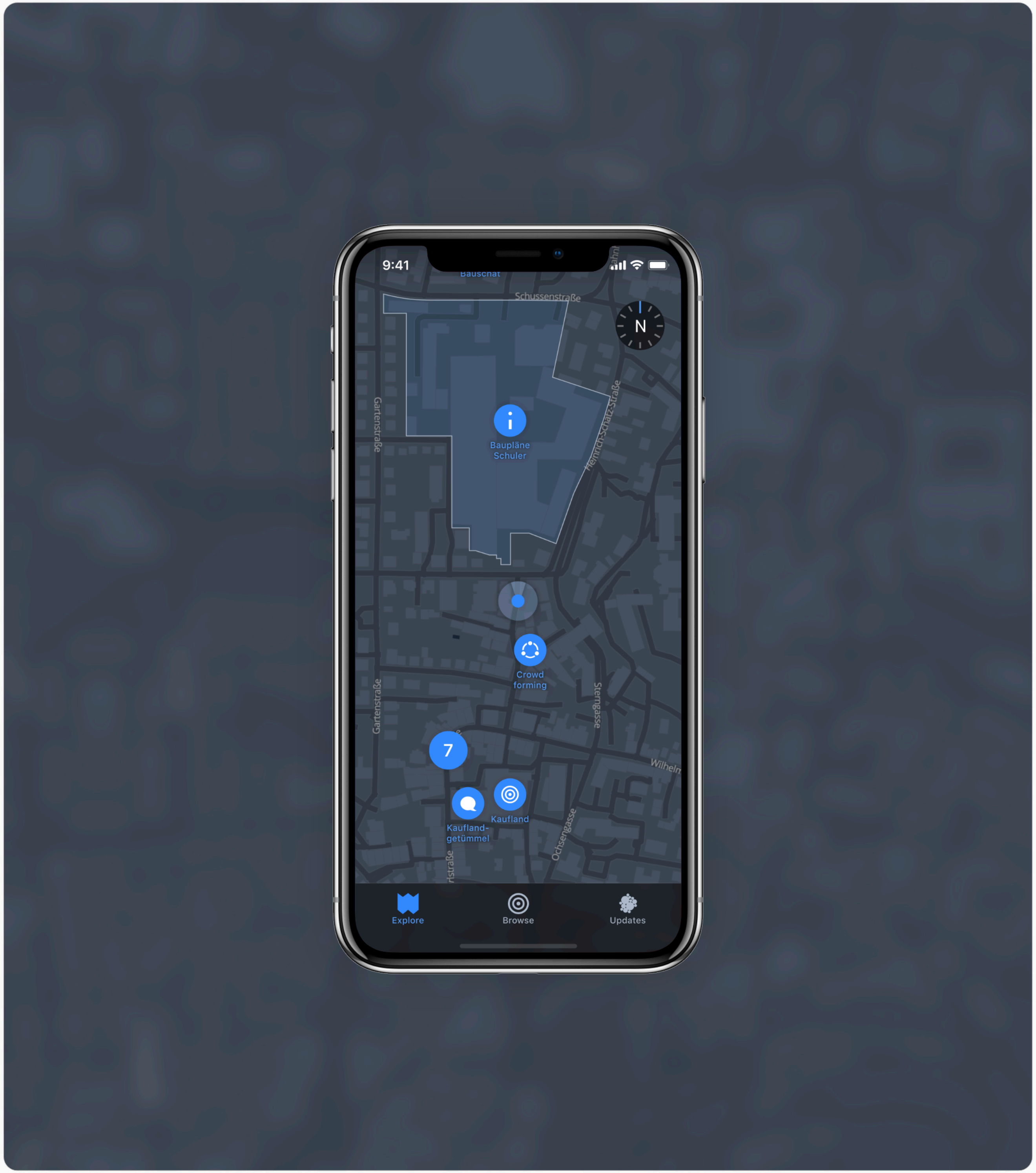


Fig. 14: Mock-up of the ‘Explore’ tab in Proximity. The map shows the immediate vicinity around the user’s location.

experience gap as the gap between the experience users expect and the experience they actually have with a product or service.

I developed a concept for a smartphone app designed to bridge this experience gap and named it “Proximity”. The concept combined city announcements, commercial features for shopping and social features for networking all in one app, displayed on a map.

I gathered data on this concept through **interviews and questionnaires.** Among other things, it emerged that companies would prefer a web app for data entry over a smartphone app. Within the scope of my project, however, I decided to focus on the end-user-oriented iOS version of the smartphone app.

To further develop the concept, I created a clickable wireframe and conducted user tests. I revised the wireframes using the insights I had gained and, building on them, designed a pixel-perfect mock-up of the iOS version in Sketch.

Fig. 15 (top): Mock-ups of the ‘Explore’, ‘Browse’ and ‘Updates’ tabs in Proximity. The Explore tab displays a push notification for a chat invitation. Browse shows businesses sorted by increasing distance. The Updates tab displays push notifications and chats. Figs. 16–21 (left to right): Wireframes. 17: Detailed view of a published construction project. 18: Notification about a gathering crowd.

Full-Service

Overview

For **See-Apotheke (pharmacy), Der Kinderarzt vom Bodensee (paediatrician)** and further clients, I had the opportunity to repeatedly work in the areas of **corporate identity, web design and development, advertising, video and audio.** This multifaceted work gave me the opportunity to collaborate with experts specializing in various fields and to learn from them.

In 2025, I decided to stop taking on new full-service clients and to focus instead on UX + UI from 2026 onwards. Nevertheless, I have included a selection of my work from the last 14 years below. These examples provide insight into my thought processes and decision-making, which I bring to my UX design work.

See-Apotheke

See-Apotheke (pharmacy) specializes in complementary medicine and adopted partially and fully automated processes early on. Between 2011 and 2025, I developed and established the pharmacy's corporate identity in several stages and updated its website three times.

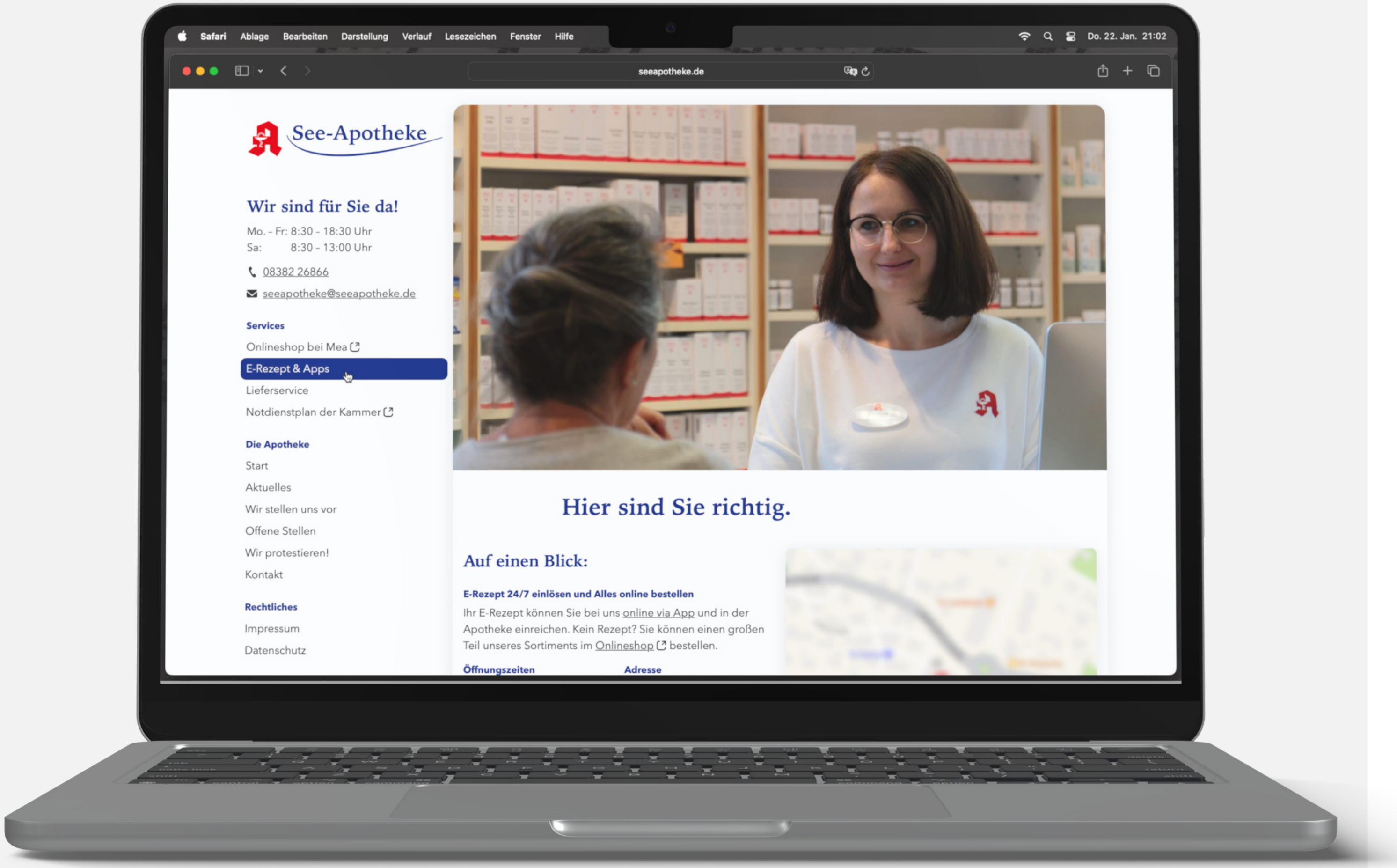


Fig. 22: Screenshot of the See-Apotheke website. Designed in Figma and built using the Kirby CMS.

A secure and user-friendly contact form

The requirements for a GDPR-compliant contact form are very high. Customers must be able to transmit health data securely to the pharmacy, as it is a category of data requiring special protection. **To this end, I designed and implemented a contact form with end-to-end encryption using OpenPGP.**

For customers, it should be possible to contact the pharmacy and send a message. They should be able to choose whether they prefer a callback or a reply by email.

For the employees, it was important not to open up an additional communication channel. They were already managing multiple chats from pharmaceutical apps in the browser, emails, several phones and an answering machine. Therefore, the form needed to be integrated into an existing channel. It was also requested that customers indicate whether they have a store card and that their postal address be requested if they used the form to place an order.

Roles: Project Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer

Project duration: four weeks

Tasks:

- Define the scope
- Design the form in Figma
- Implement using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP

Requirements

- Comply with GDPR requirements for ‘sensitive personal data’.
- Should not require a cookie banner.
- Server-side spam protection and protection against AI agents.
- The form should function as both a contact form and an order form.

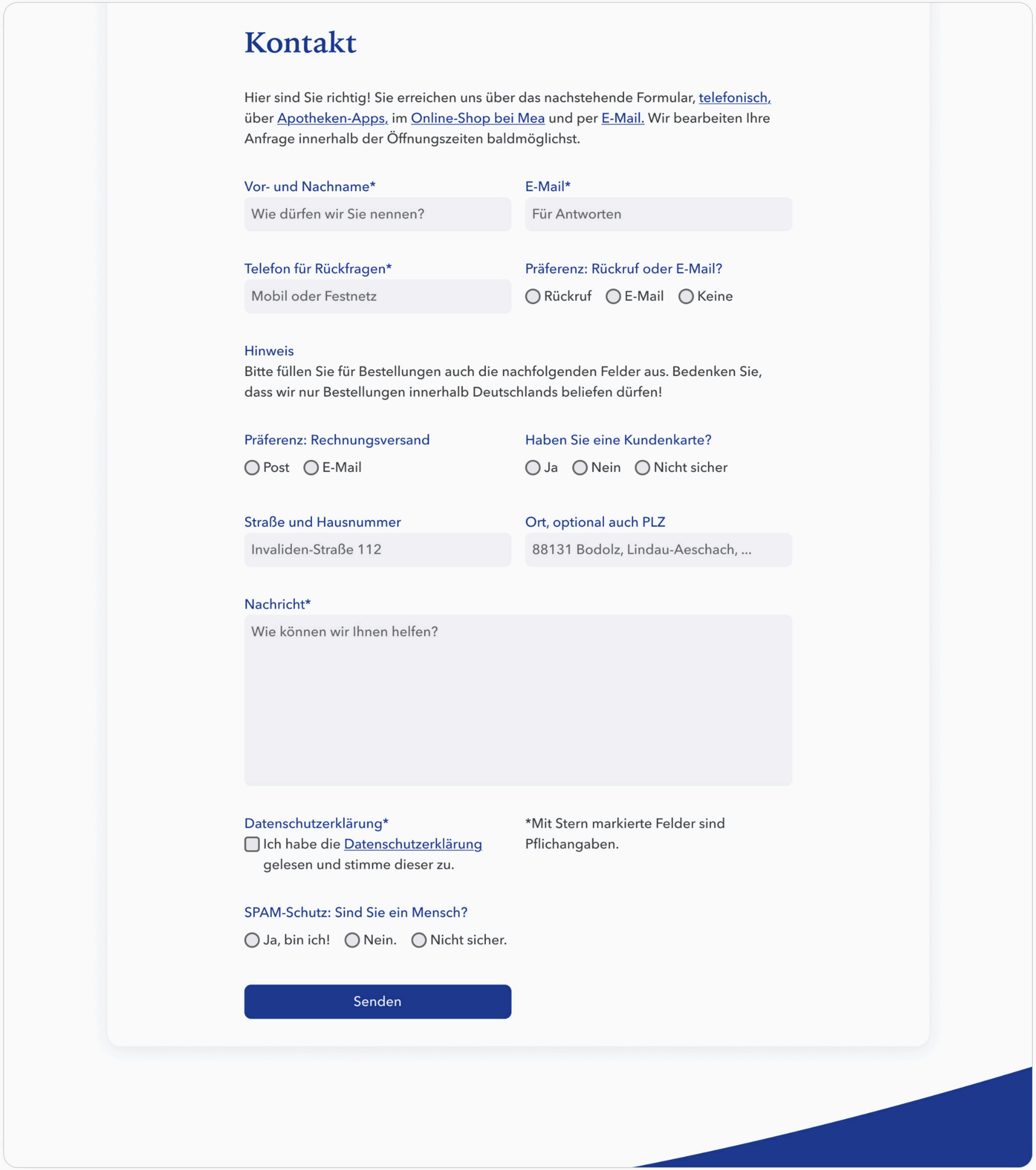


Fig. 23: Figma mock-up of the See-Apotheke contact form.

Implementation

During the UX design process, I had to rely on heuristics and internal tests with staff members, as the budget did not allow for user testing. I decided to make as few fields as possible mandatory. Only if a customer requests a callback does the phone number become a mandatory field, and only if they choose to have the invoice sent by post do the address fields become mandatory.

Using prototype-based usability and A/B tests, I would have liked to collect data on how hiding individual form fields when they are not required could have measurably improved the user experience. It would also have been beneficial to see whether users understand that the address fields become mandatory when they switch the invoice delivery method from email to postal mail, whereas otherwise they are optional. I also believe that the current CAPTCHA solution should be tested for usability. I had designed a different option in the Figma mock-up, which I would have liked to compare with the implemented solution via A/B testing.

To meet the general requirements and those of the employees, I chose the email inbox as channel. To comply with the GDPR, the transmission of data had to be end-to-end encrypted. I implemented a two-stage spam protection system. The form includes a honeypot for AI bots, as well as a CAPTCHA that does not rely on third-party services to avoid a cookie banner.

To help with filling in the fields on mobile devices, the fields automatically switch to the appropriate keyboard for free text, email, or phone numbers. At the same time, I implemented predefined input patterns and microformats in the code to enable the browser and browser plug-ins to automatically fill in the address, email and phone fields.

As a further aid, the cursor jumps to the telephone field if a customer changes their preferred response method from email to telephone while the phone number input is still blank.

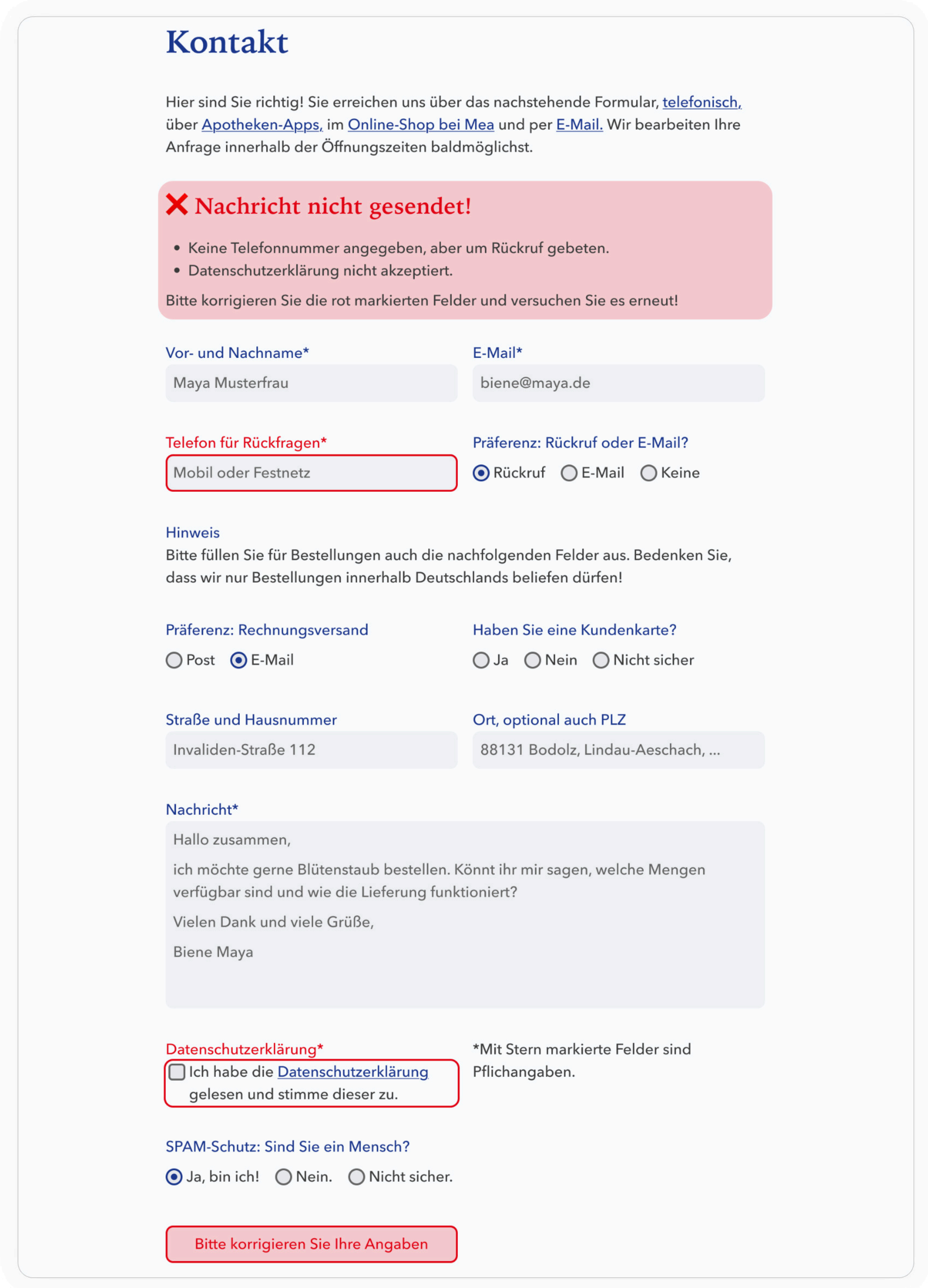


Fig. 24: Figma mock-up of the See-Apotheke contact form showing input errors.

Exterior advertising

Abb. 25: Foto der See-Apotheke von außen (Sommer 2025), Teil der Ostseite.

Abb. 26: Foto der See-Apotheke von außen (Sommer 2025), Teil der Nordseite.

Roles: Project Manager, CX Designer, Graphic Designer

Project duration: six weeks

Tasks:

• Develop advertising concept

• Measurements and initial designs

• Design

• Liaise with the print shop and installation team

There are large windows on two sides of the retail area, the space where products are displayed and consultations take place. A footpath runs alongside these windows. The aim was to create privacy for consultations whilst maximizing wall space to install shelving. However, the retail area needed to remain full of natural light.

Turning problems into opportunities

The exterior advertising will remain unchanged for several years, so I developed a concept where the content will remain relevant in the long term. By applying graphics to the windows and the rear entrance, just over 14m² of highly valuable advertising space is created, clearly visible from a footpath and a B-road.

Since the introduction of digital prescriptions, it has been a challenge for the pharmacy to inform customers about the option of ordering their medication online from their local pharmacy. This is particularly important for tourists, for whom this information will likely remain novel. The pharmacy offers a free, same-day regional delivery service. It is therefore often a day faster than Doc Morris or Apotheke.de. I decided to focus on these two points:

• Submitting and ordering online prescriptions

• Free, same-day regional delivery

At the rear entrance, the view through the glass door must be fully blocked outside opening hours. I decided to use this space to display information on pharmacy apps, opening hours and more.

Der Kinderarzt vom Bodensee

Dr. med. Christof Metzler, Kinder- und Jugendarzt

Dr Christof Metzler is a paediatrician. He runs a YouTube channel for parents and grandparents, where he discusses topics from his medical practice. He is the author of several books, which he also distributes as audiobooks. I worked with him on several web, video and social media projects from 2011 onwards, which also allowed me to gain experience as a video editor.

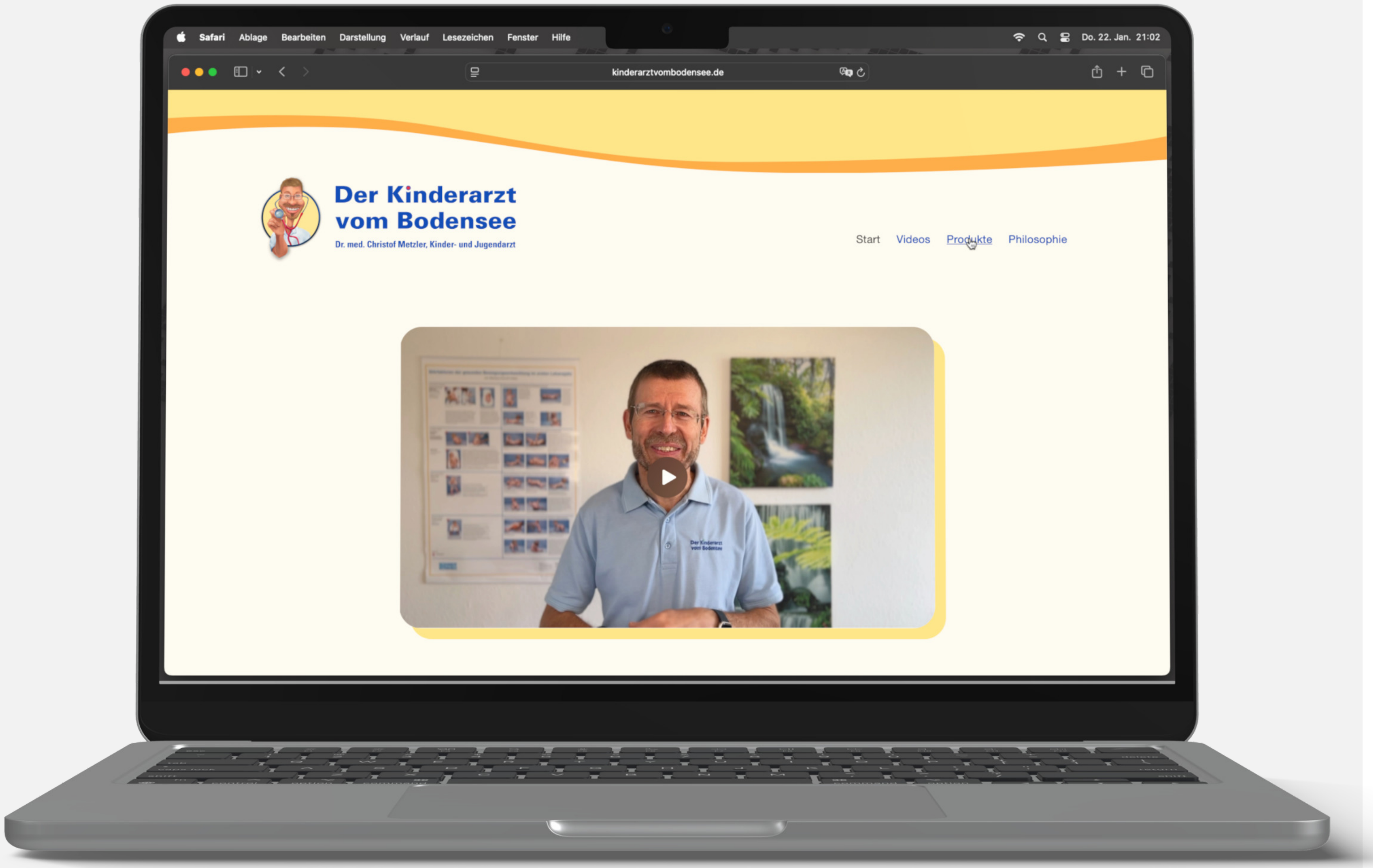


Fig. 27: Screenshot of the published website www.KinderarztVomBodensee.de

A home of his own, online

In 2022, Dr Metzler asked me to modernize his website, which had become rather outdated since 2011. As a first step, he wanted to create an independent platform where he could present more than just his videos. The modernization was also intended to lay the groundwork for easily implementing a shop system and a newsletter system in the future.

Roles: Project Manager, UX and UI Designer for Web, Web Developer

Project duration: four months

Tasks:

• UX and UI design for web

• Programming the website using the Kirby CMS

• Training third parties to enter existing data

Decisions

Dr Metzler gave me complete freedom in project planning and implementation; the only constraint was the financial budget. His top priority was flexibility and future scalability of the website. In this first step, he wanted to replace the old website from 2011 as cost-effectively and quickly as possible.

I began with rough sketches on paper, as this approach, due to its low level of precision, can rapidly lead to tangible results. Within a few days, I was able to start creating initial mock-ups in Figma, which I developed into prototypes within the first week.

The prototypes proved essential for further fine-tuning the design. They allowed us to collaborate via video conferences and coordinate detailed decisions with the graphic designer in charge of the CI. Ideally, I would have liked to test the search function on the video page through user testing and refine it based on the findings. However, to stay within budget, we removed the search function from the product.

When it came to developing the website, we had the choice between WordPress and Kirby CMS. After analysing the available plugins for Kirby in relation to shop systems, we opted for the leaner Kirby CMS to implement the website.

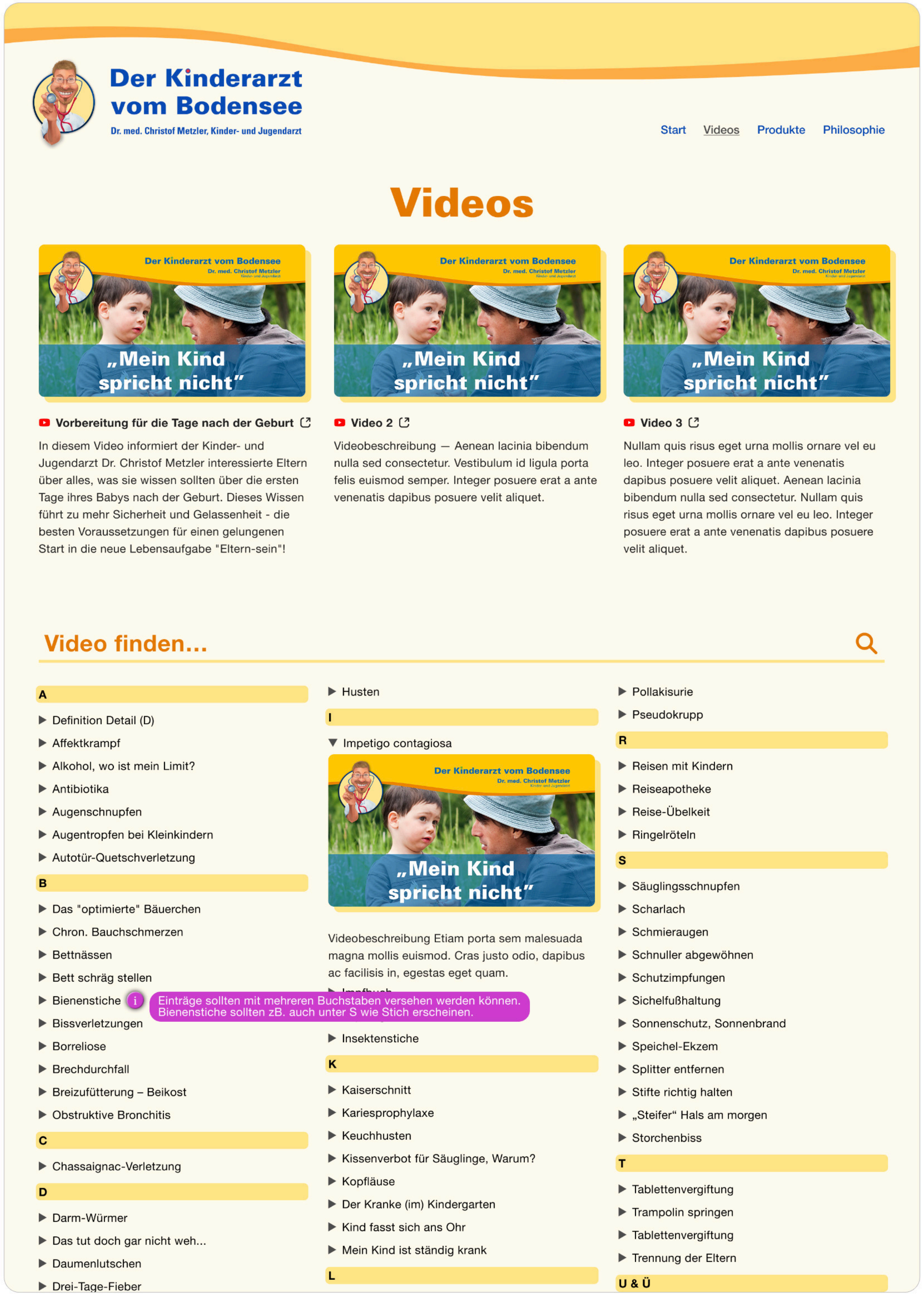


Fig. 28: Figma mock-up of the Videos page with search function.